

Power Move 1: Own The Identity Factor



The Identity Exercise

Answer these questions like money is on the line, because it is. This is where you stop negotiating with yourself and put your brand into words your team can actually use.

You are building a reference point: a shared understanding of who the company is, what it really offers, how it communicates, and what it will protect.

This exercise is not meant to replace a full brand development process, nor is it a substitute for comprehensive brand guidelines.

A skilled branding agent would take what you clarify here and translate it into the full system—messaging, standards, and eventually the visual expression that signals your identity to the world.

However, I don't want you to mistake "simple" for "small." If you complete this exercise honestly, you'll clarify enough in one sitting to change how you make decisions, how you communicate, and how your team represents your business.

HOW TO USE THIS

Answer in plain language.

Be specific enough that two different people would make the same decision.

If you're stuck, write the "first true sentence," then refine.

Keep this to one page.

PART 1: BEING (WHO WE ARE)

Company identity in one sentence

"We are a company that _____."

What we stand for (3–5 commitments)

Write commitments, not adjectives.

We commit to _____

We commit to _____

We commit to _____

We commit to _____

We commit to _____

What we refuse (3–5 non-negotiables)

These are boundaries you will protect even when it costs you.

We refuse _____

We refuse _____

We refuse _____

We refuse _____

We refuse _____

Our version of better (inside our niche)

“In our industry, ‘better’ means _____ because _____.”

PART 2: OFFER (WHAT WE REALLY PROVIDE)

What we sell (deliverables)

List the obvious outputs.

What we really offer (transformation)

“Our customers don’t just get _____. They get _____.”

The problem we solve (root, not symptoms)

"We solve _____ by _____."

Proof of value (how we know it worked)

"We know we delivered when _____."

PART 3: VOICE (HOW WE COMMUNICATE)

Our voice in 3 words:

Our tone shifts by context

When we teach, we sound like _____

When we sell, we sound like _____

When we correct, we sound like _____

When we support, we sound like _____

Words we use / words we don't use

We say:

We avoid:

The line we will not cross to get a sale.

"We will not _____ even if it would increase conversions."

PART 4: MISSION (WHY WE EXIST AND WHERE WE'RE GOING)

Mission (what we do daily)

"Our mission is to _____ for _____."

Vision (what we're building over time)

"Our vision is a world where _____."

Causes and alignment (what we support)

"We align with _____ because _____."

PART 5: STANDARDS (HOW WE PROTECT THE BRAND)

Experience standards (what customers can always expect)

They can always expect _____

They can always expect _____

They can always expect _____

Decision filter (brand decisions vs business decisions)

Before we say yes to a new offer, partnership, hire, or shortcut, we ask:

- Does this strengthen or cheapen what people bought into?
- Does this align with our commitments and non-negotiables?
- Would we be proud to be known for this?
- Does this move the mission forward or just move money?
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PART 6: TEAM CLARITY (SO NOBODY HAS TO GUESS)

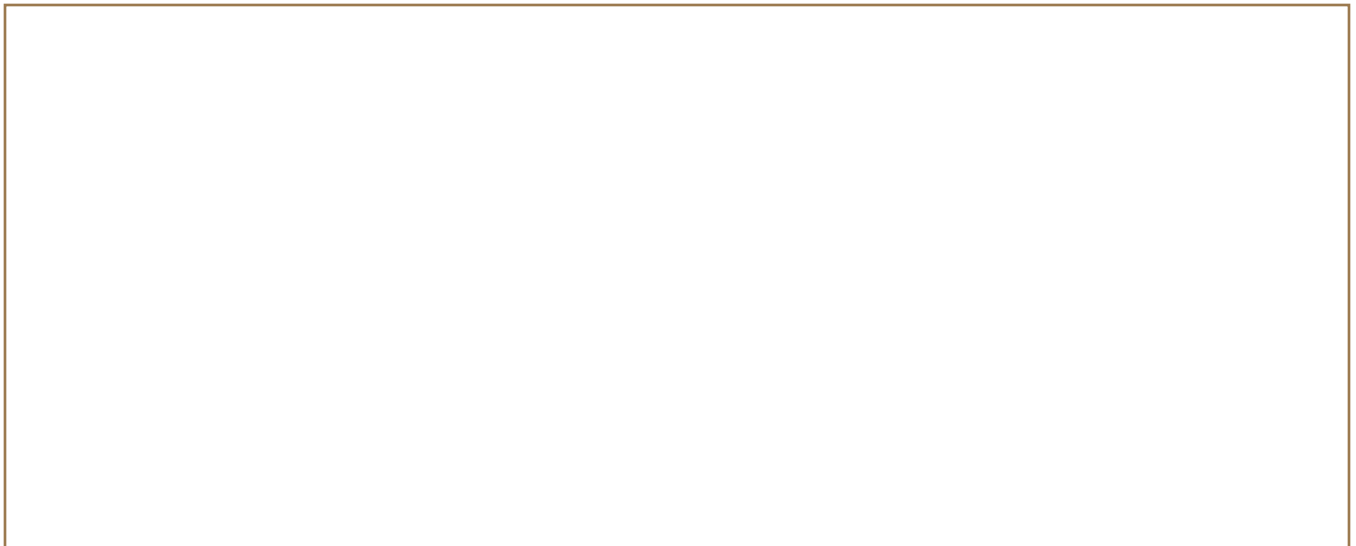
If you're new here, here's what matters most

Write 3–5 sentences that a team member can remember.



If you're representing us publicly, protect this.

List what must stay consistent across emails, calls, DMs, proposals, and service delivery.



FINAL CHECK

If two different team members filled this out, would they sound like the same company?

If not, don't redesign anything yet. Define identity first.

The Tool: The Purpose Map

This is your output for this chapter. Don't just read it; define it. This map keeps your identity grounded and usable.

1. Passion: What do we care about enough to keep improving, even when it's hard?

2. Aptitude: What do we do exceptionally well (or have the potential to become exceptional at)?

3. People Served: Who is helped by our work? (Primary customer, employees, specific community).

4. Problem Removed: What specific burden do we reduce for them?

5. Outcome Delivered: What becomes better? (Name both the practical result and the emotional shift).

6. Our Version of Better (Plain English): Write 1–2 sentences naming the specific improvement we make in the slice of the world we touch. Example: "We make construction projects predictable so owners can sleep at night."

7. Standards: What must be true every single time we deliver?

8. Impact Level: Where do we focus our impact? (Customer / Workplace / Community).